If he allowed me to go to Princeton University to study liquid propulsion, and gave the nod for the French connection, it was partly because of his theory of letting people do what they want to do. So, in a way, I was a beneficiary of some of Sarabhai's ways of which I was critical about.

I remember a conversation with Sarabhai where he showed great interest in liquid propulsion; it was about the V2 engine developed by the Germans. His eyes lit up when he was told about how the Germans used the rocket engine to fire ammunition across the English Channel during World War II. He probably saw liquid also as a fuel for missiles, but for now, solid was ruling the roost, and Sarabhai did not want to disturb the course.

Given Sarabhai's deep sense of patriotism and interest in matters of the nation's defence, though he remained India's face of peaceful application of space science, a missile-powered India could have been well within his agenda.

While many Indians may still disagree with this, the US and some other developed nations realised this early, and they were not happy with it. Do I have proof for this? Not everything can be proved, like the cause of death of Sarabhai.